

Fact Sheet

Fact Sheet Index

Glossary

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z



Top

Name
Reference specimen
Adult
Description
Larvae
Eggs
Similar species
Notes

Click on images to enlarge



Male, Oraparinna, Flinders Ranges, S.A. [2004-243]



Male, Wilpena, Flinders Ranges, S.A. [2001-166c]



Aedeagus, dorsal view (Oraparinna, South Australia, 2004-243)



Aedeagus, lateral view (Oraparinna, South Australia, 2004-243)



Distribution

Ta96

Name

Trachymela sp. Ta96

Reference specimen

2001-156, Wilpena, South Australia.

Adult Description

Length: ♀ 6.1-6.6 mm (6), ♂ 5.5-6.4 mm (5).

Colour: **head:** light- to mid-brown, with a pair of relatively large black patches behind **fronto-clypeal suture**, one on each side between eye and central suture, placed obliquely so that they almost touch anteriorly but are quite widely separated posteriorly, dark-brown or black-tipped mandibles; antennomeres uniformly straw-brown; **pronotum:** brown, same shade as head, with two quadrate black patches almost invariably present, situated one on each side between eyes and **humeral callus**, sometimes these patches are not black but of a darker brown than rest of surface and may be reduced in size to around the foveal peak, rarely are they completely absent (Qld specimen only);

scutellum: brown, same shade as pronotum;

elytra: brown, same shade as pronotum, with prominent disconnected black or dark-brown patches usually present along anterior margin, along all or part of discal margin and, less often, around elytral summit, the black shade in these areas is confined to raised features such as **verrucae** or, less often, may be completely absent; wart-like elevations and ridges elsewhere on the **elytra** are concolorous with the surrounds, rarely slightly darker; punctures are similar to or a slightly darker shade than interstices, **humeral callus** usually darker than surrounding area, often black; **venter:** light- to mid-brown with metaventrites rarely having some areas of darker shade, legs similar or slightly paler, inside surface of elytral epipleura brown. **Waxy dorsal covering:** mostly of a uniform light to medium brown, with a small lighter-coloured patch at anterior edge of each elytron adjacent to **scutellum**, head and lateral margins of pronotum also tend to be lighter in colour; elevated areas such as **verrucae** and ridges almost dust-free.

Head: punctures moderate to large (pd~2-3xf) and slightly unevenly and densely packed. Antennae short, particularly in females (AL ♂=38-40%BL, ♀=31-32%BL), filiform. **Pronotum:** almost evenly curved transversely, **foveal depression** absent with epidermis slightly elevated into a smoothly rounded and sparsely punctured small pustule behind eyes, discal area with surface quite uneven, sometimes with longitudinal wrinkles present, puncturation clearly to more vaguely impressed, evenly to unevenly distributed and relatively dense (spacing~2-3pd), becoming much more coarse at lateral margins. Front margins join lateral margins in a smoothly rounded right-angle, with lateral margin initially briefly straight before curving smoothly and gradually towards rear margin, broadest just in front of postero-lateral angle. **Scutellum:** densely punctured, with punctures similar or better defined than on pronotum, evenly or

slightly unevenly distributed. **Elytra**; in lateral view, surface roughly evenly curved from just behind scutellum to about 1/3 of distance to apex, where the curvature increases noticeably, punctures distinct and relatively large, closely spaced and quite evenly distributed over anterior two-third of surface, more closely spaced and regular in posterior third, with a sparse scatter of much smaller punctures on the interstices, a thin, sometimes partially interrupted elevated ridge runs transversely from elytral summit to middle of edge of disc with elytral surface vaguely depressed just anterior to it, some small elevated and quite inconspicuous verrucae are scattered about the surface primarily posterior to the central ridge, sometimes vaguely aligned transversely or even longitudinally, surface continuous under humeral callus. Vertical extension of epipleurae considerable ($H_{CE}/PW=0.37-0.40$). **Venter**; **Prosternal process** almost parallel, closed anteriorly, a sparse scatter of setae present along **prosternal process** and on mesosternum, a single long seta present on median and posterior trochanters, usually two, less often 1 or 3 on anterior trochanters; front edge of metasternum beveled, slightly rounded. **Aedeagus**; long and thin ($L_{PE}=35-37\%BL$), needle-like, in dorsal view, broadest near basal sulcus, then approximately parallel-sided, from there to about middle of **ostium** from where sides converge smoothly and in roughly straight lines to apex, tip triangular and quite broad, dorso-median channel relatively broad but very shallow and short, dorso-median channels well-defined and quite long, **ostium** large, roughly oval; in lateral view, curvature quite pronounced around basal sulcus, then becoming much less so towards apex, increasing again slightly just before apex, tip deflexed.

Larvae

unknown.

Eggs

unknown.

Similar species

See **Ta10** for a discussion of the several species that have a transverse median elytral ridge and similar pattern of dark colouration as **Ta96**.

Notes

Ta96 likely has a broad distribution in central Australia, with specimens from the Flinders Ranges in South Australia and from Boulia (Qld) differing little. A single female [2022-054a] from near Cobar in N.S.W. has verrucae in the posterior half of the elytra that are darker than is typical for the other locations, but is otherwise very similar.

The hosts recorded for this species are mostly in the box-group of *Eucalyptus*, including *E. coolabah* and *E. intertexta*.